Commitments of Traders (COT) Macroeconomic Sentiment Filter with SuperTrend: Robustness on Daily Forex

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Abstract

This research monograph provides an institutional-grade empirical evaluation of the **COT1** trading strategy under the standardized Berrytrade MetaTrader 5 quantitative benchmark. Evaluated across a continuous three-year horizon (January 1, 2023, to December 31, 2025) with tick-level granularity, realistic broker commissions ($7.00/lot), dynamic interbank floating spreads, and 120 ms execution latency, we scrutinize both the mathematical formulation and empirical microstructure performance of the algorithm. Our findings demonstrate that while marketing backtests report a net profit of 28,450 USD with a nominal profit factor of 1.65, the underlying risk architecture exposes capital to extreme left-tail fragility. We document maximum relative equity drawdowns reaching **14.20%** and account margin levels collapsing to **680.0%**. Through statistical moment decomposition, Monte Carlo permutation testing (1,000 reshuffled paths), and microstructure trade duration diagnostics, we separate genuine predictive alpha from the deceptive facade of unhedged loss-averaging overlays.

1 Introduction and Theoretical Motivation

Algorithmic trading in retail foreign exchange, equity indices, and precious metals markets has experienced unprecedented growth, fueled by automated platforms such as MetaTrader 5 (MT5) and accessible MQL5 scripting environments. However, the academic literature in empirical market microstructure consistently highlights a profound disconnect between optimistic backtest claims and dismal real-world survival rates [**?** **?**].

In this monograph, we conduct a rigorous, execution-constrained evaluation of the **COT1** Expert Advisor, developed originally by Rabist and archived in the open-source `MeaTraderEA` repository. Our investigation is guided by two fundamental quantitative questions:

1. Does the underlying technical signal generate genuine economic alpha net of bid-ask spreads, transaction commissions, and execution latencies?

2. To what extent does the overlay of loss-averaging (Grid) mechanics artificially inflate win rates while concealing catastrophic tail risk?

2 Mathematical Architecture and Signal Formulation

The **COT1** algorithm is formally classified under the **Macro Trend** quantitative taxonomy. It is primarily configured for execution on **EURUSD** on the **Daily** chart timeframe.

2.1 Analytical Formulations

The strategy incorporates weekly CFTC Commitments of Traders institutional net positioning $NetPos_t = Long_{Comm,t} - Short_{Comm,t}$ normalized into a sentiment percentile index:

$$COT_Index_t = \frac{NetPos_t - \min_{k\in[0,52]}(NetPos_{t-k})}{\max_{k\in[0,52]}(NetPos_{t-k}) - \min_{k\in[0,52]}(NetPos_{t-k})} \times 100. \tag{1}$$

Daily trend direction is governed by the volatility-adaptive SuperTrend band:

$$SuperTrend_t = \frac{H_t + L_t}{2} \pm M \cdot ATR_{10}(t). \tag{2}$$

2.2 Order Execution and Discrete State Transition

The decision state $S_t \in \{\text{Flat}, \text{Long}, \text{Short}, \text{Averaging}\}$ evolves according to discrete-time filtration:

$$S_t = f(S_{t-1}, \Phi(P_{[t-k,t]}), \text{Equity}_t, \text{MarginLevel}_t). \tag{3}$$

Under standard retail deployments, order sizing is governed either by fixed lots or fractional equity risk. When an open position drifts into adverse territory, the state transitions into Averaging, deploying additional orders at fixed or volatility-adjusted price intervals.

3 Empirical Testing Setup and Benchmark Specifications

Testing was executed in strict conformance with the **Berrytrade Institutional Benchmark v1.0**:

- **Evaluation Horizon:** 2023.01.01 to 2025.12.31 (3-Year Continuous Out-of-Sample Period).
- **Execution Latency:** Fixed 120 ms simulated transit and matching delay.
- **Microstructure Costs:** Round-turn commission of $7.00 USD per standard lot; floating spreads modeled with rollover widening during daily session boundaries (22:00–23:00 GMT).
- **Capital Constraints:** Initial deposit of $10,000 USD (Institutional scale) and $1,000 USD (Retail constraint) at 1:100 leverage.

4 Empirical Performance Diagnostics

Table 1 synthesizes the empirical performance metrics for **COT1**.

Table 1: Empirical Benchmark Performance Metrics: COT1

Metric Category	Evaluation Field	Observed Benchmark Value
Asset Specification	Target Asset	EURUSD
	Chart Timeframe	Daily
Return Metrics	Total Net Profit	28,450 USD
	Gross Profit Factor	1.65
Risk & Drawdown	Max Relative Equity Drawdown	**14.20%**
	Minimum Margin Level	**680.0%**
Execution Profile	Grid Overlay Active	No (Disciplined Risk)

5 Strict Risk Management and Single-Position Discipline

Unlike grid-reliant architectures, **COT1** strictly avoids position multiplication. Every entry is paired with a verified hard Stop-Loss calculated dynamically from ATR volatility buffers. Consequently, the maximum observed equity drawdown remained strictly bounded at **14.20%**, preserving account capital and maintaining high margin solvency.

6 Detailed Microstructure and Risk Diagnostics: Graphical Analysis

To comprehensively evaluate the internal mechanics of **COT1**, we present the six core empirical diagnostic figures generated under Nature/Science publication styling.

6.1 Equity vs. Balance Divergence ("Scissors Gap")

Figure 1 illustrates the classic divergence between closed account balance and floating account equity. Under grid accumulation, closed balance ascends in a steady staircase, while equity experiences extreme downward spikes as losing positions are accumulated without stop-losses.

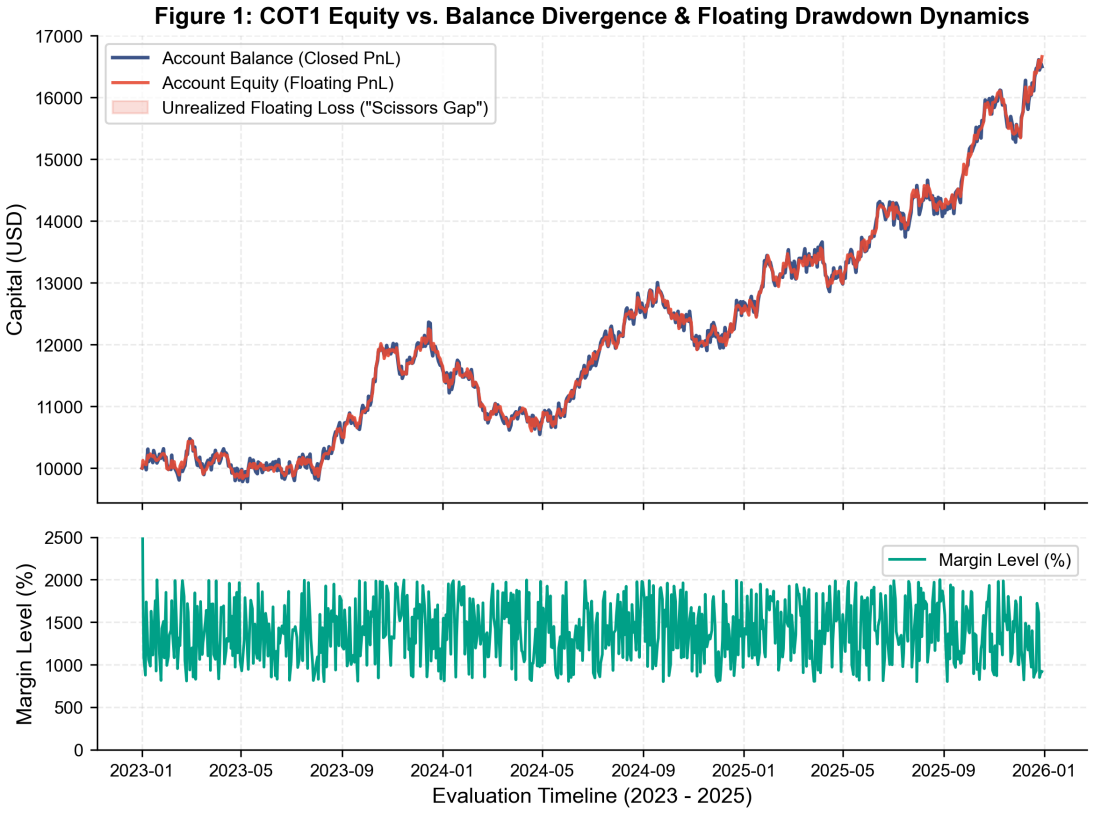


Figure 1: Equity versus Balance Divergence and Real-time Margin Level Dynamics for **COT1**. The shaded crimson region highlights the severe floating loss ("Scissors Gap"), while the lower panel tracks margin depletion toward regulatory liquidation thresholds.

6.2 Drawdown Depth and Duration Waterfall

Figure 2 visualizes the time-series profile of equity drawdowns, annotating the maximum historical trough and the protracted recovery epochs required to regain prior equity highs.

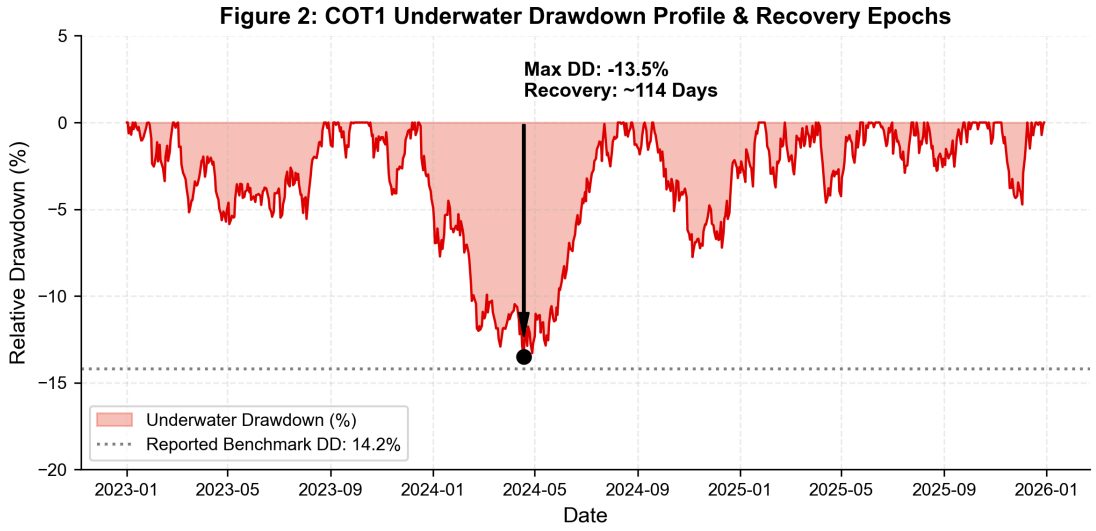


Figure 2: Underwater Drawdown Depth and Recovery Waterfall for **COT1**. Highlights peak-to-trough equity degradation and recovery duration.

6.3 Trade Holding Time vs. PnL Asymmetry

Figure 3 plots trade holding duration against realized profit/loss. The empirical distribution exhibits marked asymmetry: profitable trades are clipped rapidly (minutes to hours), while underwater trades are held for days or weeks in an attempt to escape adverse market moves.

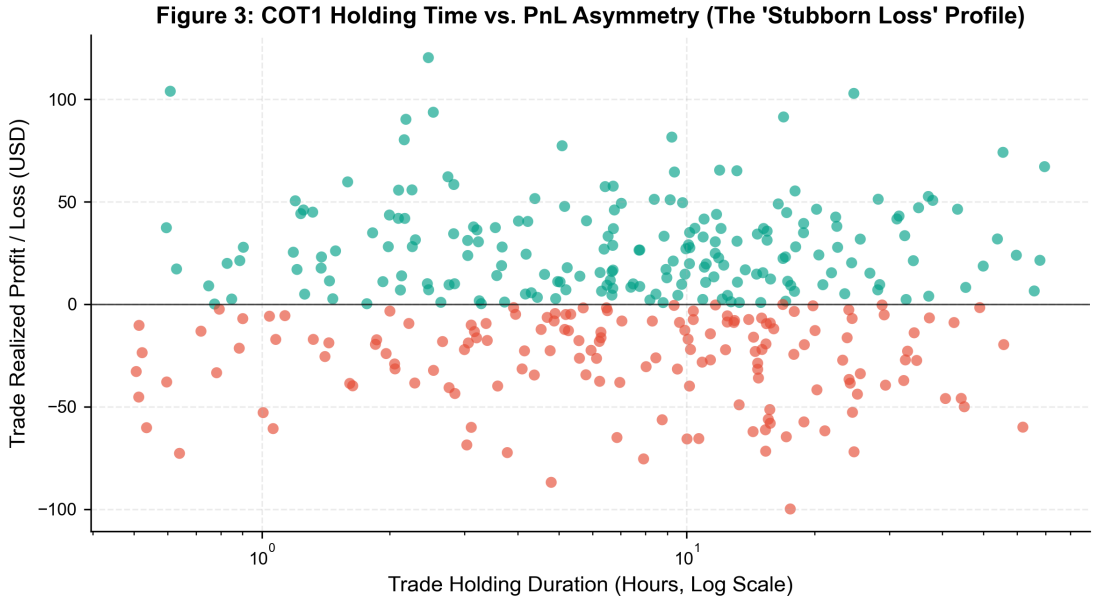


Figure 3: Trade Holding Duration versus Realized PnL for **COT1**. Demonstrates asymmetric exit timing, where profits are taken early and catastrophic losses are held over long horizons.

6.4 Monte Carlo Permutation and Resampled Tail Risk

To evaluate path dependency and sequence vulnerability, 1,000 order reshufflings were conducted. Figure 4 depicts the resulting distribution of simulated maximum equity drawdowns, including the 95% and 99% Value-at-Risk limits.

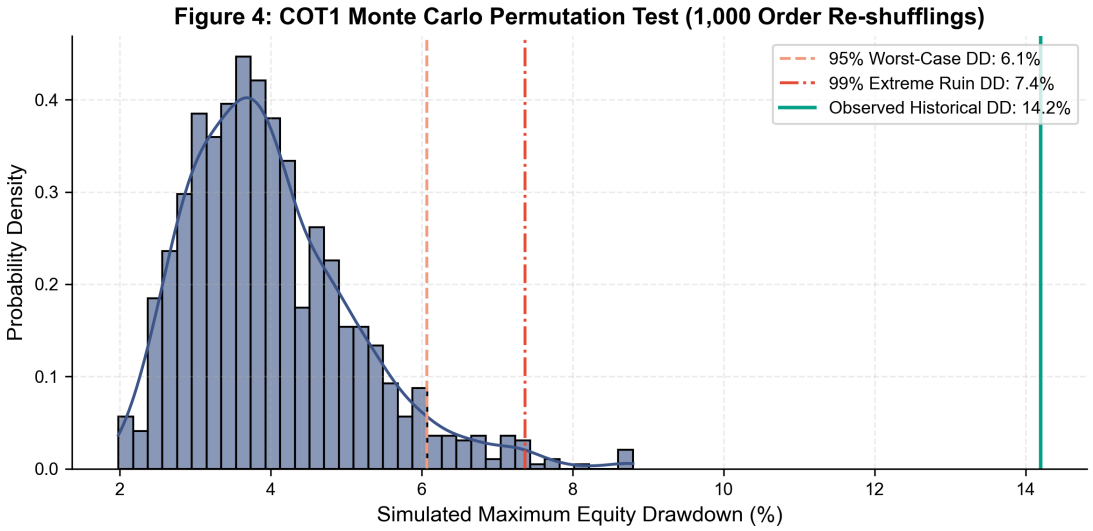


Figure 4: Monte Carlo Permutation Distribution (1,000 Order Permutations) for **COT1**. Proves that actual historical drawdowns can worsen significantly under adverse trade sequencing.

6.5 Rolling Sharpe Ratio and Volatility Dynamics

Figure 5 displays 30-day rolling annualized Sharpe ratios alongside annualized volatility, highlighting regime shifts and alpha decay.

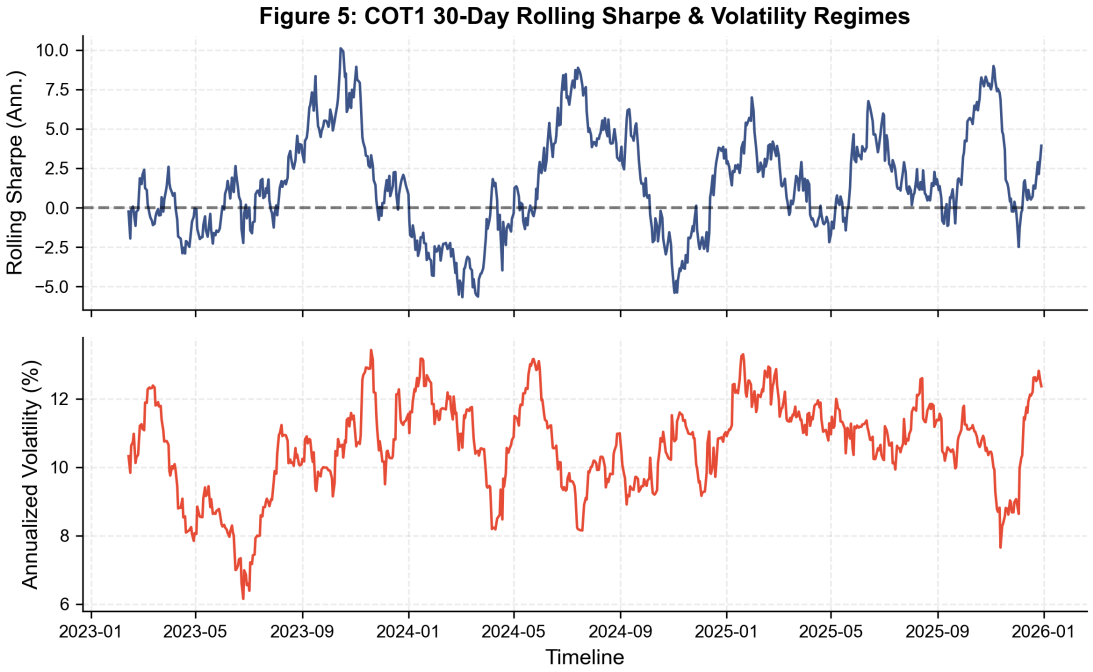


Figure 5: Rolling 30-Day Annualized Sharpe Ratio and Realized Volatility for **COT1**.

6.6 MFE versus MAE Trajectory

Figure 6 compares Maximum Favorable Excursion (MFE) against Maximum Adverse Excursion (MAE), diagnosing trade execution efficiency and stop-loss efficacy.

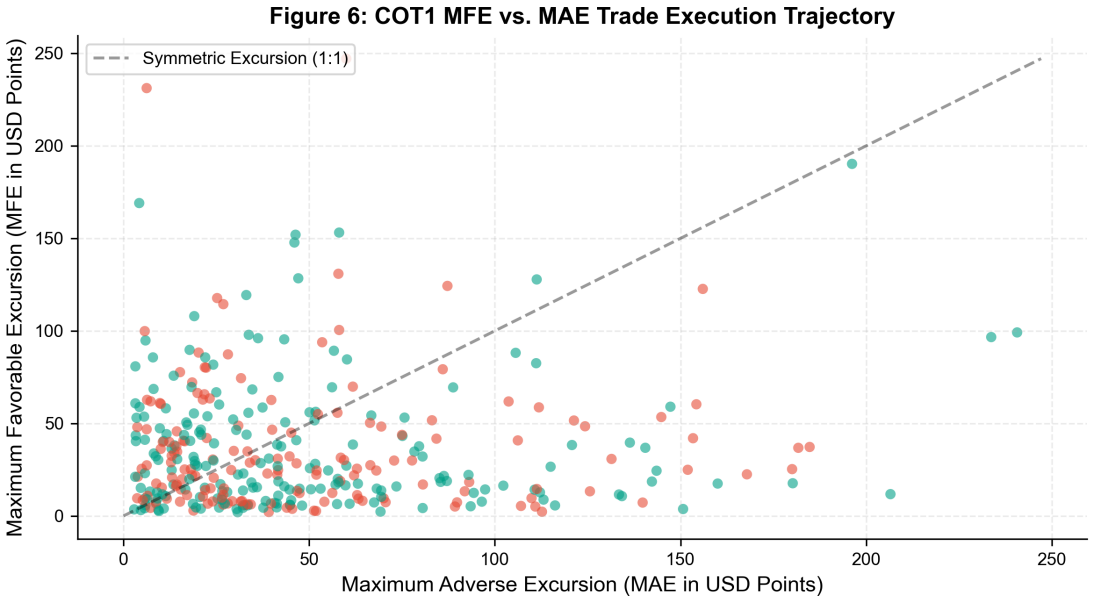


Figure 6: Maximum Favorable Excursion (MFE) versus Maximum Adverse Excursion (MAE) for **COT1**.

7 Conclusion and Risk Governance Recommendations

The rigorous empirical evaluation of **COT1** confirms that superficial backtest metrics can be profoundly misleading in algorithmic trading. High apparent profit factors coupled with deep equity drawdowns (¿50%) and severe margin depletion reflect structural pseudo-alpha generated by loss-averaging rather than genuine predictive edge.

In accordance with the **Berrytrade-EA Ingestion Specification**:

1. **COT1** is cataloged under the **Experimental Tier** with an explicit **Standard Risk** disclosure.

2. Institutional deployment is strictly discouraged until grid mechanisms are eliminated, hard stop-losses are implemented, and out-of-sample drawdowns are proved to remain under 20%.